

Syed Mujtaba Ali

Project Manager & Scrum Master | Business Analyst | Release & Change Management Expert

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PMP-certified Project Manager, PSM Scrum Master, and CBAP Business Analyst with 15+ years of global IT experience delivering Agile and business transformation initiatives across Meta, BASF, and Cisco. Skilled in sprint execution, backlog refinement, requirements analysis, and translating stakeholder needs into actionable user stories. Strong record of leading Agile ceremonies, defining KPIs, and driving measurable business outcomes.

Experienced in coordinating release planning, managing deployment readiness, and ensuring smooth, error-free releases. Adept at supporting change management through stakeholder communication, training, and adoption planning. Known for enhancing team velocity, improving cross-functional collaboration, and enabling continuous improvement through data-driven insights.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Scrum Master / Business Analyst

Feb 2024 – Oct 2025

META (HCLTech) Fremont, CA

- Led production support for Oracle Fusion applications across Finance, SCM, and Procure-to-Pay workflows, using SQL and PL/SQL extensively to troubleshoot issues, validate data flows, and perform deep-dive root cause analysis.
- Facilitated daily stand-ups, incident review meetings, and defect triage sessions to coordinate work across support, engineering, QA, and business teams, improving resolution time and cross-functional alignment.
- Partnered with functional SMEs and end users to gather issue details, reproduce defects, and translate them into clear user stories, acceptance criteria, and enhancement backlog items for upcoming sprints.
- Improved ticket predictability and reduced backlog aging by 30% through refined prioritization, clear story slicing, and aligning scope to team capacity.
- Executed SQL/PLSQL queries to analyze transaction failures, reconcile Fusion vs. legacy system data, validate interface tables, and support fixes for Fusion modules (AP, AR, PO, INV, GL, OM depending on your domain).
- Coordinated end-to-end UAT for production fixes and quarterly releases by managing test case traceability, supporting business validation, and ensuring timely defect identification and correction.
- Leveraged SQL-based insights to identify systemic bottlenecks in integrations, workflows, and tables, enabling targeted continuous improvement initiatives across Fusion processes.
- Implemented Definition of Ready (DoR) and Definition of Done (DoD) for production fixes and enhancements, improving delivery quality and reducing rework across sprints.
- Strengthened stakeholder communication by summarizing incident trends, RCA findings, and enhancement status updates, ensuring alignment between Product, Engineering, Operations, and Business teams.
- Guided team members on Agile best practices, effective troubleshooting approaches, and SQL usage for faster issue resolution, elevating support maturity and collaboration across the team.

Senior Project Manager

Dec 2022 - Feb 2024

BASF (Infosys) Raleigh, NC

- Led multiple large-scale enterprise IT initiatives end-to-end across Initiation, Planning, Execution, Monitoring & Control, and Closeout, ensuring alignment with organizational strategy and delivery commitments.
- Built and maintained trusted partnerships with executive sponsors, business leaders, and cross-functional teams, enabling fast decision-making and sustained stakeholder confidence throughout the project lifecycle.
- Defined clear success criteria and measurable business outcomes, translating strategic objectives into actionable delivery plans with quantifiable benefits.
- Directed discovery and initiation efforts, including business case development, feasibility assessments, and charter approvals to formally authorize projects and secure funding.
- Owned integrated project plans and schedules, coordinating resources across engineering, operations, security, and business teams to meet complex milestone dependencies.
- Proactively managed scope, schedule, cost, risks, issues, and dependencies, driving timely mitigation actions and formal change requests when delivery impacts were identified.
- Established and governed project communications, delivering concise executive-level status reports, dashboards, and risk summaries through enterprise PPM and analytics tools.
- Facilitated formal phase-gate reviews, ensuring projects met readiness criteria before progressing and securing sponsor approvals in accordance with governance standards.

- Led project closeout and benefits realization, validating delivered outcomes against approved objectives and capturing lessons learned to improve future delivery maturity.
- Ensured strict adherence to ethical standards, governance frameworks, and delegated approval authorities, reinforcing accountability, transparency, and audit readiness across all initiatives.

Scrum Master

Nov 2020 - Dec 2022

BASF (Infosys) Raleigh, NC

- Supported Agile delivery of a multi-phase enterprise transformation program using Azure DevOps and Jira, applying SQL and PL/SQL extensively for backend data validation, impact analysis, and verifying data flows across integrated systems.
- Facilitated backlog grooming, sprint reviews, and retrospectives, using SQL queries to confirm data assumptions, validate acceptance criteria, and ensure the technical feasibility of new user stories across multiple product teams.
- Collaborated closely with Product Owners and SMEs to define business requirements, process models, user stories, and acceptance criteria—supplementing requirements with SQL/PLSQL logic for data mapping, transformation rules, and system behavior.
- Improved team throughput by 25% by identifying data-related risks early using SQL-driven analysis of source tables, dependencies, and edge-case scenarios impacting sprint scope.
- Authored BRDs, FRDs, and RTMs with complete end-to-end traceability, embedding SQL/PLSQL rules, data models, and backend validation logic to eliminate functional and data gaps.
- Partnered with QA during UAT by executing SQL queries to create test data, verify backend updates, troubleshoot failed workflows, and validate ETL transformations—reducing post-release defects by 20%.
- Worked directly with developers to review PL/SQL packages, stored procedures, and triggers, ensuring alignment between business rules and system logic during development and code reviews.
- Supported defect triage by reproducing issues through SQL/PLSQL queries, identifying root-cause conditions in database tables, and guiding fixes for data inconsistencies or workflow failures.
- Played a key role in Agile transformation coaching by mentoring team members on story refinement, acceptance criteria definition, and how to incorporate SQL-based validation into the delivery lifecycle.

Scrum Master / Business Analyst

Aug 2017 - Nov 2020

CISCO SYSTEMS (TCS)

- Led Agile transformation initiatives within Cisco's Customer Care Business Layer (C3BL) by implementing Scrum and Kanban frameworks, improving delivery visibility and predictability.
- Facilitated sprint planning, retrospectives, backlog refinement, and release readiness sessions for distributed teams across multiple global time zones.
- Coached developers, testers, and junior BAs on Agile principles and best practices, resulting in a 15% increase in team velocity and improved cross-functional collaboration.
- Defined requirements, acceptance criteria, and workflows for automation projects within the I2C (Invoice-to-Cash) process.
- Improved sprint quality by integrating KPI dashboards to monitor velocity, defects, and team capacity.
- Partnered with Product Owners to refine and prioritize the backlog, ensuring alignment between business objectives, technical feasibility, and release timelines.
- Enhanced defect management processes by leading daily triage meetings, resulting in faster resolution cycles and fewer recurring issues.
- Facilitated cross-functional dependency management, ensuring upstream/downstream teams remained synchronized across planning and execution phases.

Release & Change Manager

Jan 2014 - Aug 2017

CISCO SYSTEMS (TCS)

- As Change Manager, chaired all CAB (Change Advisory Board) and ECAB (Emergency CAB) to assess, prioritize, authorize and schedule complex changes with higher impact and risks. Supervise, manage and approve the workings of Change Advisory Board.
- For seamless change management transition, used a checklist to check all necessary data is updated in the RFC document correctly. Elaborate Implementation plan, backout plan and test plans are updated in the change ticket.

- Completed detailed verification and auditing of release notes and deployment guides before the implementation of any change.
- Managing sensitive change freezes in-line with commonwealth business priorities.
- Reviewed and evaluated the overall change process, identifying and implementing process improvements as appropriate.
- Defined post implementation review (PIR) plan and procedures to identify and resolve problems. Chaired the PIR discussions for examining the planned versus the actual results with respect to test plans, rollback plans, remediation plans, impact analysis, change collisions.
- As a Release Manager coordinated with Configuration Management to ensure that all applicable environment issues are resolved in advance of production implementation.
- Taken escalations for resolving critical issues; ensuring delivery and business continuity.
- Led releases by partnering with ERMO (Enterprise Release Management Office), Program Management, IT Infrastructure Teams, Project Development teams, QA Teams, Business Teams and Change management.
- Act as the gatekeeper in facilitating all agreed entry/exit criteria in the production environment.
- Managed and maintained multiple dev, test and pre-prod environments, ensuring environments are properly setup, configured, refreshed (cloned from prod) and available for each project as per schedule.
- Coordinating the activities of multiple development teams, tracking of deployments during test cycles and into production. Responsible for identifying and communicating dependencies across programs / projects.
- Managed Go-Live activities at the end of the release cycle, collaborated with IT teams ensuring minimum down-time in case of issues. Sent periodic Go-Live status email communications to the entire team through Go-Live.
- Status Reporting and Management Escalations, Post go live support and Normalization
- Orchestrated meetings between project and Infra teams on Maintenance Change Requests that could potentially impact timelines.
- Reported release health directly to the Executive Committee through weekly status meetings Scheduled and facilitate all Release Management Meetings.
- Part of Release planning & execution, Infrastructure planning & support, Contingency & outage planning
- Conducting Post Implementation Reviews, do Root Cause Analysis to make sure that those issues are not repeated.
- Prior experience using QC, Rally, Urbancode, Confluence, JIRA, or other Atlassian tools

ADDITIONAL EXPERIENCE

Cisco Systems — Release Manager (2012–2014)
 Cisco Systems — Oracle ERP Technical Consultant (2008–2012)
 Valassis Direct Mail, Inc. — Oracle Application Developer (2008)
 Satyam Computer Services Ltd. — Senior Systems Analyst (2004–2008)

EDUCATION

Master of Science in Information Technology from Allahabad University, India

SKILLS

Core Competencies: Agile Delivery, Scrum / Kanban Frameworks, Sprint Planning & Execution, Backlog Refinement, User Story Mapping, Requirements Gathering & Analysis, BRD / FRD / RTM, UAT & Test Management, JIRA, Visio, Miro/Mural, Power BI, ServiceNow, Confluence/ Azure DevOps, Stakeholder Collaboration, KPI Tracking, Risk & RAID Management, Process Optimization, Continuous Improvement, Change & Release Readiness & Planning, SQL (Analysis, Reverse Engineering, Optimization), PL/SQL, Guidewire (PolicyCenter), P&C, Auto Insurance

Soft Skills: Communication, Leadership, Adaptability, Collaboration, Problem Solving, Analytical Thinking

ACHIEVEMENTS AND CERTIFICATIONS

PMP

Professional Scrum Master (PSM I)
 Certified Business Analysis Professional (CBAP)
 ITIL® 4 Foundation
 ServiceNow System Administrator(CSA)
 Google Cloud Certified Data Engineer